yehudon”, the ex-aide, Aviv Bushinsky, said in a debate on Channel 2. The word, a diminutive of the Hebrew for “Jew”, could be variously translated as “little Jew boy”, or as “kike”. “It’s the behavior of Jews who are trying to show that they are extra left-wing, more liberal and more balanced,” Bushinsky added. Shapiro was the third US ambassador to earn the sobriquet, alongside Daniel Kurtzer and Martin Indyk, the latter of whom was once an executive at AIPAC. An Israeli diplomat described it as “the worst slur a Jew can use against another Jew.”

Bushinsky had been out of politics for a decade. He was speaking as a media commentator, a private individual, not on behalf of the prime minister. His comments would not have merited a mention, were it not for the torrent of vitriol directed at President Obama a year later after he abstained from vetoing a symbolic Security Council resolution that reiterated long-standing criticism of Israeli settlements. Far from being an outlier, it proved that Bushinsky’s remark was really a leading indicator.

Israelis, unsurprisingly, stereotype American Jews: the overly-exuberant kids with bad Hebrew stumbling off the Birthright buses; the pasty beachgoers cowering under umbrellas to avoid the Mediterranean sun. For a section of the Israeli right, though, there is also a genuine hostility toward the American Jewish community, at least when it comes to issues of war and peace. Over the past seventy years, the United States has given Israel close to a quarter-trillion dollars in military aid, constant diplomatic support, and the highest level of intelligence sharing and cooperation granted to a non-NATO state. Even so half of Israeli Jews, and 62 per cent of those who identify as right-wing, feel the US is insufficiently supportive of Israel.

This is, on the merits, an absurd argument. But it has nothing to do with the merits. The Israeli right resents the fact that the American government occasionally complains about its half-century occupation of the Palestinians, and it has become increasingly forthright about that resentment. “Nobody was standing there with a hammer forcing him to say it,” Bushinsky added.

”Worse than kapos”

In August, an unusual press release popped up in my inbox. A big red headline blared, “for the first time, the Trump campaign goes into Israeli